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AFP

TRUMP GIVEN ROYAL WELCOME ON SECOND UK VISIT

■ **Left to right (on the dais):** US First Lady Melania Trump, US President Donald Trump, Britain's King Charles III and Queen Camilla stand with Catherine, Princess of Wales (left) and Prince William, Prince of Wales (second left), during a ceremonial welcome in the Quadrangle at Windsor Castle, in Windsor, yesterday, during the US President's second state visit to the UK.

SEE ALSO P10

Cabinet approves Dh30b economic clusters policy

MOHAMMAD CHAIRS FIRST CABINET MEETING OF SEASON

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday chaired the first Cabinet meeting of the new government season at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi.

Among the first decisions adopted was the approval of the National Policy for Economic Clusters, aimed at creating groups of industries, services, and institutions of similar nature at the national level, while capitalising on the competitive advantages of each emirate, the Vice-President said in a post on his official X account.

The policy seeks to strengthen these sectors, develop their capabilities, and support their access to global markets.

Enhancing competitiveness

The policy is expected to generate an annual added value of more than Dh30 billion to the country's GDP and will enhance the overall global competitiveness of the national economy.

The Cabinet also approved the agenda of the UAE Govern-

The policy is aimed at creating groups of industries, services, and institutions of similar nature at the national level, while capitalising on the competitive advantages of each emirate.

ment Annual Meetings, scheduled to take place in Abu Dhabi on November 4-6, with the participation of the country's 500 most senior government officials. This year's agenda will focus on education, health care, family and national identity, the economy, and artificial intelligence applications. The meetings aim to reinforce the spirit of national team while consolidating the competitiveness of government services, institutions, and strategies.

The Cabinet also approved the updated National Plan to Reduce Aviation Sector Emissions, as part of the UAE's global environmental commitments.

The meeting reviewed the outcomes of the National Environment Policy, which aims to safeguard sustainability and preserve the country's diverse natural and biological resources,

as well as the results of the National Air Quality Agenda 2031, which coordinates federal and local efforts in this field. "Preserving the environment will remain a central pillar of the UAE's sustainable development journey," Shaikh Mohammad reaffirmed.

85 international deals

The Cabinet approved the reconstitution of the Board of Trustees of the Anwar Gargash Diplomatic Academy, the UAE Council for Digital Economy, and the Entrepreneurship Council. It endorsed and authorised the signing of 85 international agreements and memoranda of understanding across multiple sectors and approved the hosting of 12 specialised international events supported by the UAE government.

Shaikh Mohammad wrote: "Today we also approved the establishment of the UAE Council for Integrative Medicine, chaired by Shaikha Salama Bint Tahnoon Bin Mohammad Al Nahyan. Integrative medicine combines modern medicine with all forms of traditional practices. It is a holistic approach that addresses the health of the body, mind, and spirit to improve prevention and treatment."

SEE ALSO P5

EU proposes curbing Israel trade ties

Commission also calls for sanctioning ministers over Gaza

BRUSSELS

The European Union yesterday proposed curbing trade ties with Israel and sanctioning ministers in its strongest action over the war in Gaza, though reluctance from key member states risks blocking the measures' adoption. The bloc's executive said it would

take immediate action by itself by freezing some €20 million in bilateral support for Israel.

Mounting pressure

The move from the EU's executive comes as pressure has mounted on the 27-nation bloc to take action against Israel over its devastating near-two-year offensive in Gaza. "The horrific events taking place in Gaza on a daily basis must stop," EU chief Ursula von der Leyen said.

"There needs to be an immediate ceasefire, unrestrained

access for all humanitarian aid, and the release of all hostages held by Hamas," she added.

Under its new proposals, Brussels is pressing to suspend parts of a cooperation deal with Israel that allow for reduced tariffs on goods coming from the country. The commission also called for asset freezes and visa bans on far-right Israeli ministers Itamar Ben Gvir and Bezalel Smotrich, whose "extremist" rhetoric is blamed for fuelling the violence.

— AFP

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NATION

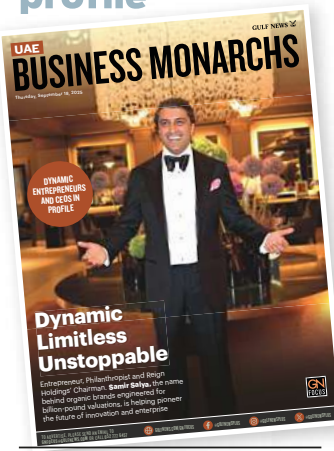
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